

NAME: CH.SRI LAKSHMI

REG NO: 192311342

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COURSE NAME: CLOUD COMPUTING AND BIG DATA ANALYTICS

ASSESSMENT TOOL-4

ANALYTICAL PROBLEM SOLVING

1.Compare Type-1 and Type-2 hypervisors for a cloud data center hosting mission-critical applications. Analyze performance, security, and manageability, then justify the better choice.

Ans) Compare Type-1 and Type-2 Hypervisors for a Cloud Datacenter Hosting Mission-Critical Applications

Feature	Type-1 Hypervisor	Type-2 Hypervisor
Installation	Runs directly on hardware	Runs on a host operating system
Performance	High, low overhead	Lower due to OS overhead
Security	More secure with smaller attack surface	Less secure because host OS can be attacked
Manageability	Easy centralized management and live migration	Suitable only for testing and development
Examples	Oracle VMware ESXi, Microsoft Hyper-V, Xen Workstation VirtualBox, VMware	

Analysis:

- Type-1 hypervisors provide near-native performance because they communicate directly with hardware.
- They offer stronger security by eliminating dependence on a host operating system.
- They support enterprise features such as live migration, clustering, high availability, and fault tolerance.

- Type-2 hypervisors consume additional resources because the guest OS depends on the host OS.

Justification:

For mission-critical cloud applications, **Type-1 Hypervisor** is the better choice because it provides high performance, improved security, higher availability, better scalability, and easier centralized management.

2. A cloud provider must isolate workloads belonging to finance, healthcare, and student portals on the same hardware. Analyze how virtualization architecture supports isolation and identify two major attack surfaces.

Ans) Virtualization Architecture for Workload Isolation

A cloud provider hosts finance, healthcare, and student portal applications on the same physical server.

How Virtualization Supports Isolation:

- Each workload runs inside its own Virtual Machine (VM).
- Every VM has separate CPU, memory, storage, and networking.
- A failure or malware attack in one VM does not affect other VMs.
- Hypervisor enforces strict resource isolation and access control.

Major Attack Surfaces:

1. Hypervisor Attack

- If attackers compromise the hypervisor, they can gain access to all virtual machines.

2. VM Escape Attack

- Malware escapes from one VM and interacts with the host or other VMs.

Conclusion:

Virtualization provides secure multi-tenancy through strong isolation, while protecting against threats using hypervisor hardening, network segmentation, encryption, and regular security updates.

3. Study the following VM host utilization snapshot and recommend corrective actions: CPU 92%, memory 88%, storage I/O latency 35 ms, average VM boot time 170 s. Explain the likely bottlenecks.

Ans) VM Host Utilization Analysis

Given:

- CPU Utilization = **92%**
- Memory Utilization = **88%**
- Storage I/O Latency = **35 ms**

- Average VM Boot Time = **170 s**

Analysis of Bottlenecks:

CPU (92%)

- CPU is heavily utilized.
- Too many VMs share limited processor resources.
- Result: Slow application response.

Memory (88%)

- Memory usage is very high.
- Hypervisor may begin memory swapping.
- Result: Reduced VM performance.

Storage I/O Latency (35 ms)

- Storage latency is much higher than the recommended (<10 ms).
- Indicates disk bottleneck.
- Result: Slow read/write operations and delayed VM startup.

VM Boot Time (170 s)

- VM startup is much longer than normal.
- Caused by CPU overload, memory pressure, and slow storage.

Corrective Actions

- Upgrade CPU resources or distribute workloads.
- Increase RAM capacity.
- Replace HDD storage with SSD/NVMe storage.
- Enable load balancing and live migration.
- Remove unused VMs and optimize resource allocation.

Conclusion

The main bottlenecks are overloaded CPU, insufficient memory, and slow storage, leading to high VM boot times and reduced cloud performance.

4. Analyze how Software Defined Datacenter architecture improves agility compared with a traditional datacenter. Support your answer with compute, storage, and network virtualization considerations.

Ans) Software Defined Datacenter (SDDC) vs Traditional Datacenter

Traditional Datacenter	Software Defined Datacenter
Manual configuration	Automated management
Fixed hardware resources	Virtualized resources
Slow deployment	Rapid provisioning
Limited scalability	Highly scalable

Compute Virtualization

- Virtual machines can be created, migrated, or deleted automatically.
- Better resource utilization.

Storage Virtualization

- Combines multiple storage devices into a single virtual storage pool.
- Enables snapshots, replication, and easier management.

Network Virtualization

- Creates software-defined virtual networks.
- Supports micro-segmentation and software-controlled routing.

How SDDC Improves Agility

- Faster deployment of applications.
- Automatic scaling.
- Reduced operational cost.
- Centralized management.
- Improved disaster recovery.

Conclusion

Software Defined Datacenters provide greater flexibility, automation, scalability, and efficient resource management compared to traditional datacenters.

5. A multi-cloud federation project fails due to identity mismatches between providers. Analyze the issue and propose a secure identity and privacy design using federation concepts.

Ans) Multi-Cloud Federation Identity Problem

Problem

Different cloud providers use different identity management systems, causing:

- Login failures
- Authentication mismatches
- Authorization conflicts
- Duplicate user accounts

Analysis

Secure Identity and Privacy Design

Identity Federation

- Implement Single Sign-On (SSO).
- Use a trusted Identity Provider (IdP).

Standard Protocols

- SAML 2.0
- OAuth 2.0
- OpenID Connect (OIDC)

Privacy Protection

- Encrypt user credentials.
- Use Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Apply Role-Based Access Control (RBAC).
- Share only necessary user information.
- Maintain audit logs and continuous monitoring.

Benefits

- One login across multiple cloud providers.
- Secure authentication.
- Reduced identity duplication.
- Better privacy protection.
- Simplified user management.

Conclusion

Identity federation using SAML/OAuth/OpenID Connect with MFA, RBAC, and encryption provides secure authentication and privacy across multi-cloud environments.